

JAIDEEP PHATAK, PMP®

Project Manager & Technical Program Manager | Automotive VAVE, Benchmarking & Portfolio Governance |

80+ Engineers Led Across 3 Continents | AI-Augmented Delivery

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Automotive program manager with 10+ years of experience, including 7+ years directing VAVE, benchmarking, and cross-functional programs across OEM and Tier-1 supplier environments in the USA, UAE, and India. Directed 80+ engineers across the USA, UAE, and India spanning APAC, EU, and North American OEM accounts, with direct CXO-level steering committee accountability across \$8M–\$10M+ in cumulative program budgets and 35+ programs. Delivered \$200/vehicle in realised VAVE cost savings and ~20kg/vehicle weight reduction across mid-size SUV, ICE, and BEV platforms, alongside a 40% reduction in programme cycle times through structured governance and process standardisation. Combines execution-level operational depth - having started on the floor running teardown and benchmarking operations - with AI-enabled reporting, Power BI dashboards, and Lean Six Sigma execution.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Scale & Leadership:** 80+ engineers directed across the USA, UAE, and India, spanning APAC, EU, and North American OEM programs, with direct CXO steering committee reporting
- **Portfolio Governance:** 35+ programs governed across cumulative portfolios of \$8M–\$10M+ (Trucks, SUVs, EVs, BEV), achieving 95%+ on-time delivery through stage-gate governance, Gate Reviews, and RAID management
- **Cost & Value Engineering:** \$200/vehicle in realised VAVE cost savings and ~20kg/vehicle weight reduction delivered across mid-size SUV, ICE, and BEV platforms
- **Delivery Transformation:** 40% reduction in programme cycle times (20–24 weeks to 12–14 weeks) and First-Time-Right quality improvement from ~50% to ~90% through SOP standardisation and process redesign
- **Resource Optimisation:** Billable utilisation improved from ~60% to ~80% through structured resource planning and utilisation-matrix tracking

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance – AI Training Associate & Executive Program Portfolio Development

Jun 2026 – Present

Pune, India

- Engaged as an AI training associate with Micro1, evaluating and refining English-language model responses for clarity, accuracy, and natural communication
- Concurrently building an executive portfolio of AI-enabled Program & Portfolio Command Centers, governance dashboards, and stage-gate control systems, alongside targeted coursework in AI-augmented programme management

Project Manager

Oct 2025 – May 2026

Caresoft Technologies LLC OPC | Ras Al Khaimah, UAE

- **OEM Technical Program Lead:** Directed technical programme delivery and cost-reduction initiatives for 3 global OEMs, leading a 30-member engineering team across UAE and India
- **Training & Enablement:** Delivered 60–70 training sessions across 10 OEM clients and 25+ Tier-1/Tier-2 suppliers; developed role-specific curricula that reduced recurring escalations
- **Idea Governance & Compliance:** Owned lifecycle tracking of ~200 tool ideas across engineering and product teams (~50% approval rate); conducted ~32 on-site compliance audits across UAE facilities with zero unresolved escalations

Project Manager

Apr 2024 – Sep 2025

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- Resumed Project Manager role with expanded scope, assuming full operational ownership of the US delivery facility and a globally distributed team of 80+ engineers (50 onsite USA, 28–30 India)
- **Portfolio Governance:** Managed 15 benchmarking programmes (up to 9 concurrent) across a \$3M+ budget spanning Trucks, SUVs, Sedans, and EVs on ICE/Hybrid/EV platforms, contributing to 2–3 new OEM engagements and 2–3 contract renewals

- **Team Performance:** Improved billable utilisation from ~60% to ~80% and First-Time-Right delivery from ~50% to ~90% through structured QA/QC and resource-planning programmes
- **AI-Driven Efficiency:** Introduced AI-automated status reporting and utilisation dashboards, reducing manual reporting overhead and improving stakeholder visibility across 9 concurrent programmes

Senior VAVE Engineer

Jul 2023 – Apr 2024

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- Lateral move into a dual technical-managerial role, delivering end-to-end cost and mass-reduction programmes for 3 global OEMs across Full-Size SUV and BEV segments
- **VAVE Delivery:** Identified, validated, and secured OEM sign-off on VAVE cost/mass-reduction opportunities, delivering \$200/vehicle in savings and ~20kg/vehicle mass reduction
- **Technical Leadership:** Provided strategic direction to a 15–20 member VA/VE engineering team, bridging engineering execution with programme governance across concurrent OEM engagements

Project Manager

Feb 2023 – Jun 2023

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- Established structured programme delivery for 5 automotive benchmarking programmes (up to 3 concurrent), coordinating a 60-member cross-functional team (40 onsite USA, 20 India) across SUVs on EV, ICE, and Hybrid platforms
- **Budget & Process Governance:** Owned \$1M–\$1.5M per customer-driven programme and \$800K–\$1M for internal programmes, delivering 4 of 5 on time and within budget; performed RAID analysis and published lessons-learned reports carried forward into subsequent cycles

Automotive Benchmarking Analyst

Sep 2019 – Feb 2023

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- Progressed from individual contributor to on-site Team Lead and Project Lead, managing end-to-end benchmarking operations for 18 programmes across Trucks, SUVs, and Sedans (ICE, Hybrid, EV), coordinating a 40-member on-site team
- **Global Standardisation:** Contributed to the company's expansion from 2 to 6 global facilities; developed and standardised 20 SOPs and 35 process checklists across functions
- **Cycle Time & Team Development:** Crashed full-vehicle programme cycle times from 20–24 weeks to 12–14 weeks (~40% reduction); onboarded and trained 15–20 new associates, building a self-sufficient, high-output team

CORE COMPETENCIES

VAVE & Cost Engineering | Program & Portfolio Governance | Engineering Change Management | Lean Six Sigma (DMAIC) | Program Stage-Gate & Gate Reviews | APQP / PPAP | DFMEA | Product Lifecycle Management (PLM) | Power BI & KPI Dashboards | OEM Customer Management | Cross-Functional Team Leadership | Risk Identification & Mitigation | Agile / Waterfall / Hybrid Delivery | Budget & Cost Control | Process Standardisation

TOOLS & PLATFORMS

MS Project | Jira | Confluence | Power BI | Excel (Advanced) | SAP (exposure) | SharePoint | Monday.com | Asana | Google Workspace | GenAI (Claude, Copilot, ChatGPT, Gemini)

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Mechanical Engineering

2017 – 2018

Lamar University, Beaumont, Texas, USA | GPA: 3.54 / 4.0

Bachelor of Engineering, Mechanical Engineering

Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune, India

CERTIFICATIONS

- PMP® – Project Management Professional (Project Management Institute)
- AI for Project Management (LinkedIn Learning)
- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt (LSSGB) – Udemy